

lovers it provides a converter which makes it one of the most versatile LCDs.

Making a choice

We received a total of 12 top quality LCDs. These LCDs were expensive too, with the average price over three times that of conventional CRT monitors.

15-inch LCD monitors: Here **Philips 150MT** came up as the clear cut choice for our Best Performance award. It notched up an overall score of 62.51 and included a host of features such as a built-in TV Tuner with PiP (picture in picture) option.

The best value for money that a user can get in this category is from **Sharp LL-T15V1**. It's overall score was 58.16 and it comes with a distinct price advantage—it costs almost half the price of Philips 150MT.

17-inch LCD monitors: We received only four models here. The competition here was largely between Samsung's SyncMaster 171MP and LG's FLatron 782LE.



LG's FLatron 782LE (17-inch LCD monitor)

Samsung's SyncMaster 171MP walked away with our Best Performance award in this category due to its top-notch design and top class performance (overall score of 68). The Best Value award in this category went to **LG's FLatron 782LE**. With a decent overall score of 52.16 and a price of just above Rs 50,000, it makes for a good buy.

18-inch LCD monitors: 18-inch LCD monitors are still rather out of reach for most users in terms of availability and price—we received just two pieces for testing. The Digit Best Performance award winner was **Viewsonic VP181**. It scored a good 65.32 points with a price tag of Rs 1,55,000.

The competitor in this category was **Sony SDM-N80**. It was the only LCD monitor in this comparison test to use an external power supply, which made it resemble a small CPU. Coming at a very attractive

price of Rs 1,29,000, and with an overall score of 62.29, this one is our choice for the Best Value award in this category.

Philips 150MT

Philips 150MT provides the user with an array of ports for connecting a DVD player, Video CD player and a VCR. It also has a TV coaxial-IN port and includes the PiP feature.



In our test, this LCD scored extremely well in the sharpness and resolution test—there was no pixel bleeding or blurring. This ensures sharp and clear images, making movie watching a joy on this monitor. It also scored extremely well on the features front. Its performance in the other tests was just about average, however.

Though it's priced high, it does include a plethora of features and should prove to be a good buy for those who like to mix work and play.

Samsung SyncMaster 171 MP

This one is a masterpiece when one looks at the design. It also performed excep-



tionally well in the viewable angle and sharpness resolution test. There was no colour tinge on the LCD even when viewed from an 80-degree angle. At that angle, we were able to read the document displayed on the screen, but not very clearly.

In the Pixel Response Time test, we noticed a lot of blurring while running the *Quake III* demo. So if gaming is what gets you going, this one's not for you. Overall, this LCD combines good looks with performance.

Sony SDM-N80

If you are looking for a sleek LCD, which would match your tastefully furnished house, then your search should end with the Sony SDM-N80. This extremely well designed unit provides the user with a back-lit panel. Strangely, it has a separate power unit that mounts all the connectors. This was the only LCD we received that had such a feature. This LCD came with a DVI-A-to-VGA cable. Considering the fact that it's difficult to find a standard DVI digital cable, it would have been better if Sony had included it along with



this product. One nice feature about this LCD was its ability to automatically adjust brightness to varying light conditions.

It was the highest scorer in the sharpness and resolution test—the pixels displayed were extremely bright, with no visible blurring. In the rest of the tests, it scored equally well, except in the viewable angle test where its performance was below average. When viewing the screen at an 80-degree angle, we couldn't read the document. Plus there was a noticeable colour tinge.

Overall, Sony SDM-N80 is quite reasonably priced considering the features it provides. 

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